GRADE 11 TECHPRO ACTIVITY SHEET

CSS LINKS AND LINK BUTTONS

ICT / Computer Programming | Grade 11 | Visual Studio Code

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Identify :link, :visited, :hover, and :active.
- Style hyperlinks using color, background-color, text-decoration, and other CSS properties.
- Create link buttons using padding, borders, display, and hover effects.
- Build a TechPro Learning Links page in Visual Studio Code.

A. GETTING STARTED

Materials: Computer, Visual Studio Code, and a web browser.

1. Create a folder named CSS_Links_Activity.

2. Open it in Visual Studio Code.

3. Create index.html.

4. Copy the starter code at the end of this sheet.

5. Save the file and open it in a browser. Refresh after every change.

B. ACTIVITY 1 — STYLE TEXT LINKS

Test the link in the starter page by moving the mouse over it and clicking it.

Task 1: Change the normal link color to dark blue or another color you choose.

Task 2: Add text-decoration: none; to remove the underline. Then underline the link on hover.

Task 3: Use font-weight: bold; and background-color to make the link stand out.

Task 4: Test the states: :link (unvisited), :visited (visited), :hover (pointer over link), and :active (while clicking).

C. ACTIVITY 2 — CREATE LINK BUTTONS

Task 5: Add class="button-link" to an <a> element so the link can be styled like a button.

Task 6: Use background-color, color, padding, text-align, text-decoration, and display: inline-block.

Task 7: Add a border and rounded corners using border and border-radius.

Task 8: Create a hover effect that changes the background from maroon to white and the text from white to maroon.

Task 9: Create three buttons labeled Home, Learn HTML, and Learn CSS. Link each to an appropriate destination.

D. MINI-PROJECT — TECHPRO LEARNING LINKS

Create a webpage titled TechPro Learning Links. Include a heading, a short welcome message, one regular text link, and at least three link buttons.

Requirements: Use a maroon-and-white theme; style all four link states; use padding and borders; include a hover effect; ensure readable text; check that every link opens the intended destination.

Optional challenge: Add a second button style with a white background, maroon text, and maroon border.

E. SELF-CHECK AND REVIEW

Checklist:

[ ] Page opens in browser.

[ ] Regular text link styled.

[ ] Tested :link, :visited, :hover, and :active.

[ ] At least three link buttons created.

[ ] Buttons have padding and borders.

[ ] Hover effects work.

[ ] Destinations are correct.

[ ] Saved as index.html.

Review questions:

1. What does a:hover target?

   :hover targets a hyperlink when the user moves the mouse pointer over it

2. What is the difference between :link and :visited?

   :link argets unvisited links, while :visited targets links the user has already visited

3. Why should :active come after :hover?

   it follows CSS specificity (LVHA order) so active click styles properly override hover styles

4. What does text-decoration: none do?

   removes the default underline from hyperlinks

5. Why is display: inline-block useful for link buttons?

   it allows setting custom padding, margins, width, and height while keeping the link inline

6. Which property controls space inside a button?

   the padding

7. How can a hover effect help users recognize a link?

   it provides visual feedback confirming that the element is an interactive clickable link

REFERENCES

W3Schools — CSS Links: https://www.w3schools.com/css/css_link.asp

W3Schools — CSS Link Buttons: https://www.w3schools.com/css/css_link_buttons.asp

STARTER HTML CODE

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
<meta charset="UTF-8">
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
<title>TechPro Learning Links</title>
<style>
body { font-family: Arial, sans-serif; margin: 30px; line-height: 1.6; }
h1 { color: maroon; }
a:link { color: maroon; }
a:visited { color: purple; }
a:hover { color: white; background-color: maroon; }
a:active { color: gold; }
.button-link {
  display: inline-block; background-color: maroon; color: white;
  padding: 12px 20px; text-align: center; text-decoration: none;
  border: 2px solid maroon; border-radius: 6px; margin: 6px;
}
.button-link:link, .button-link:visited { color: white; }
.button-link:hover, .button-link:active {
  background-color: white; color: maroon;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<h1>TechPro Learning Links</h1>
<p><a href="https://www.w3schools.com/">Visit W3Schools</a></p>
<p><a class="button-link" href="https://www.w3schools.com/css/">Learn CSS</a></p>
<p><a class="button-link" href="https://www.w3schools.com/html/">Learn HTML</a></p>
</body>
</html>
```